



GRADE 10– ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

SECTION 1 – WORD AND STRUCTURE KNOWLEDGE

Questions 1–30

Q1. Choose the synonym of the underlined word.

The scientist gave a plausible explanation for the unusual results.

- A. impossible
- B. believable
- C. confusing
- D. irrelevant

Q2. Choose the antonym of “meticulous”.

- A. careful
- B. precise
- C. careless
- D. systematic

Q3. Choose the correctly spelt word.

- A. Entrepreneur
- B. Entreprenuer
- C. Enterpreneur
- D. Entreprenur

Q4. Complete the analogy.

Sceptic : Doubt :: Optimist : _____

- A. despair
- B. confidence
- C. suspicion
- D. hesitation

Q5. Choose the correct one-word substitution.

A person who speaks many languages is called a:

- A. linguist
- B. polyglot



- C. translator
- D. philologist

Q6. Choose the correct meaning of the idiom “to leave no stone unturned”.

- A. To avoid taking responsibility
- B. To search thoroughly for something
- C. To create unnecessary problems
- D. To give up easily

Q7. Choose the correct phrasal verb.

The investigating officer promised to _____ the matter carefully.

- A. look into
- B. look after
- C. look up
- D. look out

Q8. Choose the correct option.

Neither the students nor the teacher _____ aware of the change.

- A. were
- B. are
- C. was
- D. have been

Q9. Identify the adjective in the sentence.

The committee reached an unanimous decision after a lengthy discussion.

- A. committee
- B. reached
- C. unanimous
- D. discussion

Q10. Choose the correct preposition.

She has great confidence _____ her ability to handle the situation.

- A. on
- B. in



- C. at
- D. for

Q11. Choose the correct conjunction.

You will not succeed _____ you are willing to work consistently.

- A. unless
- B. although
- C. because
- D. whereas

Q12. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.

- A. The principal said "Discipline is essential for success."
- B. The principal said, "Discipline is essential for success."
- C. The principal said, "discipline is essential for success".
- D. The principal said "Discipline is essential for success".

Q13. Change into passive voice.

People believe that the ancient monument is over a thousand years old.

- A. It is believed that the ancient monument is over a thousand years old.
- B. It was believed that the ancient monument was over a thousand years old.
- C. The monument believed to be over a thousand years old.
- D. It has believed that the monument is over a thousand years old.

Q14. Choose the correct indirect speech.

Rahul said, "I have been preparing for the examination for two months."

- A. Rahul said that he had been preparing for the examination for two months.
- B. Rahul said that I had been preparing for the examination for two months.
- C. Rahul said that he has prepared for the examination for two months.
- D. Rahul said that he was preparing for the examination two months ago.

Q15. Choose the correct modal.

You _____ have informed the authorities immediately when you noticed the problem.

- A. should
- B. could



- C. should have
- D. may

Q16. Identify the type of sentence.

“Although the weather was unfavourable, the expedition continued because the team had prepared thoroughly.”

- A. Simple
- B. Compound
- C. Complex
- D. Compound-complex

Q17. Choose the correct tense.

By next June, she _____ her research project.

- A. completes
- B. completed
- C. will have completed
- D. has completed

Q18. Choose the correct article.

He is _____ exceptionally talented musician.

- A. a
- B. an
- C. the
- D. no article

Q19. Choose the correct option.

One of the most important qualities that a leader should possess _____ integrity.

- A. are
- B. were
- C. is
- D. have

Q20. Choose the correct question tag.

Few people understood the significance of the discovery, _____?



- A. did they?
- B. didn't they?
- C. do they?
- D. don't they?

Q21. Choose the word closest in meaning to "ambiguous".

- A. obvious
- B. unclear
- C. accurate
- D. definite

Q22. Choose the correct homophone.

The principal asked the students to _____ the instructions carefully.

- A. read
- B. reed
- C. red
- D. rede

Q23. Choose the correct word.

The new regulations will have a considerable _____ on small businesses.

- A. affect
- B. effect
- C. effected
- D. affection

Q24. Identify the figure of speech.

"Her voice was music to my ears."

- A. Simile
- B. Personification
- C. Metaphor
- D. Alliteration

Q25. Choose the correct plural form.

- A. Analysis
- B. Analyses



C. Analyses

D. Analysis'

Q26. Choose the correct word.

The two candidates exchanged _____ remarks during the debate.

A. respectful

B. respective

C. respectable

D. respectively

Q27. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.

A. If I would have known, I would have helped you.

B. If I had known, I would have helped you.

C. If I knew, I would have helped you yesterday.

D. If I have known, I would help you.

Q28. Arrange the words to form a meaningful sentence.

importance / underestimated / cannot / education / be / the / of

A. The importance of education cannot be underestimated.

B. Education cannot the importance of be underestimated.

C. The importance cannot education be of underestimated.

D. Cannot be underestimated education of the importance.

Q29. Choose the correct option.

Had I known about the traffic, I _____ earlier.

A. will leave

B. would leave

C. would have left

D. had left

Q30. Choose the word that best completes the sentence.

The lawyer presented a highly _____ argument that persuaded the jury.

A. compelling

B. fragile



- C. reluctant
- D. superficial

SECTION 2 – READING

Questions 31–40

Read the passage and answer Questions 31–35.

In recent years, artificial intelligence has moved from being a subject of science fiction to becoming part of everyday life. Recommendation systems suggest what people should watch or buy, navigation applications determine efficient routes, and language tools can translate or generate text within seconds.

However, technological progress also raises important questions. AI systems learn from large amounts of data, and the quality of their decisions can depend on the quality of that data. If the data contains errors or reflects existing biases, the resulting decisions may also be problematic.

Therefore, understanding AI does not simply mean learning how machines work. It also involves thinking critically about how technology is designed, how it is used and who is responsible for its consequences.

Q31. What is the main purpose of the passage?

- A. To prove that AI is dangerous
- B. To explain the growing role of AI and the need for responsible use
- C. To discourage people from using technology
- D. To explain how navigation applications work

Q32. According to the passage, AI systems can produce problematic decisions when:

- A. they process information quickly
- B. they use too little electricity
- C. their data contains errors or biases
- D. people use navigation applications

Q33. What does the passage suggest about understanding AI?

- A. It only requires technical knowledge.
- B. It requires critical thinking about its design and consequences.



- C. It means avoiding all AI systems.
- D. It is useful only for scientists.

Q34. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as an everyday application of AI?

- A. Recommendation systems
- B. Navigation applications
- C. Language tools
- D. Weather forecasting through traditional instruments

Q35. The word “consequences” in the passage most nearly means:

- A. causes
- B. results
- C. instructions
- D. inventions

Read the passage and answer Questions 36–40.

Urban trees are sometimes regarded merely as decorative features, but their importance extends far beyond appearance. Trees provide shade, reduce the temperature of surrounding areas and help absorb certain air pollutants. Their roots can also help manage rainwater by allowing more water to enter the soil.

Despite these benefits, urban trees often face difficult conditions. Limited space, pollution, construction and insufficient water can restrict their growth. Some cities are therefore developing long-term plans to protect existing trees while increasing green spaces.

Planting trees, however, is only the beginning. Young trees require care, adequate water and protection until they become established. A successful urban forestry programme depends on continued maintenance rather than occasional planting campaigns.

Q36. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Trees are mainly decorative.
- B. Urban trees provide important environmental benefits but require sustained care.
- C. Cities should stop constructing buildings.
- D. Young trees need no special attention.

Q37. How do trees help manage rainwater?



- A. Their leaves prevent all rainfall.
- B. Their roots allow more water to enter the soil.
- C. They increase the temperature of cities.
- D. They absorb all water from roads.

Q38. Which factor is NOT mentioned as a difficulty faced by urban trees?

- A. Pollution
- B. Limited space
- C. Construction
- D. Lack of sunlight throughout the year

Q39. What does “the beginning” refer to in the final paragraph?

- A. Protecting existing trees
- B. Planning a city
- C. Planting trees
- D. Building green spaces

Q40. What can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Planting trees without maintaining them may not produce lasting benefits.
- B. Urban trees can grow without water.
- C. Trees have no effect on urban temperatures.
- D. Tree planting campaigns are always unsuccessful.

SECTION 3 – SPOKEN AND WRITTEN EXPRESSION

Questions 41–45

Q41. During a group discussion, another student presents an opinion different from yours. What is the most appropriate response?

- A. “That’s completely ridiculous.”
- B. “I understand your point, but I see the issue differently because...”
- C. “You clearly don’t understand the topic.”
- D. “I’m not listening to that.”

Q42. You have to decline an invitation formally. Which response is most appropriate?

- A. “No, I don’t want to come.”
- B. “I can’t make it, okay?”



- C. "Thank you for the invitation. Unfortunately, I will be unable to attend."
- D. "Maybe I'll come if I feel like it."

Q43. Your friend has made a mistake in a presentation. What would be the most constructive response?

- A. "Everyone noticed your mistake."
- B. "You should never present again."
- C. "It was a minor mistake. You can improve it with some more practice."
- D. "I knew you would make a mistake."

Q44. Which is the most appropriate opening for a formal letter to a newspaper editor?

- A. Hi there!
- B. Dear friend,
- C. Sir/Madam,
- D. Hello Editor!

Q45. Which sentence is most suitable for a formal email requesting an appointment?

- A. "I need to meet you. Tell me when you're free."
- B. "Can I come tomorrow?"
- C. "I would be grateful if you could let me know a convenient time for an appointment."
- D. "Give me an appointment as soon as possible."

SECTION 4 – ACHIEVERS

Questions 46–50 | 3 marks each

Q46. Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence.

Scarcely _____ the meeting begun when the electricity _____.

- A. had / failed
- B. had / had failed
- C. did / fails
- D. was / failing

Q47. Read the statement carefully.

"Although the entrepreneur had received several offers from large companies, she refused to sell her start-up because she believed its long-term social impact was more important than immediate financial gain."



What can be inferred?

- A. She was uninterested in earning money.
- B. She valued long-term purpose over immediate financial benefit.
- C. The large companies offered no money.
- D. Her start-up had already failed.

Q48. Choose the sentence in which the modifier is used correctly.

- A. Walking through the museum, the ancient paintings fascinated me.
- B. Walking through the museum, I was fascinated by the ancient paintings.
- C. Walking through the museum, the ancient paintings were fascinating.
- D. Walking through the museum, there were many ancient paintings.

Q49. Read the paragraph and select the most appropriate connector.

The first experiment produced unexpected results. The researchers did not immediately discard their hypothesis. _____, they examined the procedure carefully and repeated the experiment under controlled conditions.

- A. Consequently
- B. Instead
- C. Nevertheless
- D. Similarly

Q50. Choose the option that best completes the paragraph.

Examinations can measure certain aspects of a student's knowledge and preparation. However, academic achievement is not determined by examination scores alone. Creativity, communication, problem-solving ability and resilience also play important roles in a student's development. _____.

- A. Therefore, examination results should be considered one measure among several aspects of learning.
- B. Therefore, examinations are completely useless.
- C. Hence, students should never prepare for examinations.
- D. Thus, examination scores always accurately predict future success.



ANSWER KEY

1. B
2. C
3. A
4. B
5. B
6. B
7. A
8. C
9. C
10. B
11. A
12. B
13. A
14. A
15. C
16. C
17. C
18. B
19. C
20. A
21. B
22. A
23. B



24. C

25. C

26. A

27. B

28. A

29. C

30. A

31. B

32. C

33. B

34. D

35. B

36. B

37. B

38. D

39. C

40. A

41. B

42. C

43. C

44. C

45. C

46. A

47. B



48. B

49. B

50. A

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